



FindIt

Campus Lost & Found Portal

Reimagining how students recover lost belongings —
from notice boards to a smart, Instagram-style platform.

Lost items on campus are a broken experience



Low visibility

Handwritten notices reach <10% of students and fade within days



No matching

No way to connect a lost wallet post with a found wallet post across channels



Scattered channels

WhatsApp groups, Instagram stories, notice boards — all unsearchable and ephemeral

~70%

of lost items are never recovered on campuses without a digital system

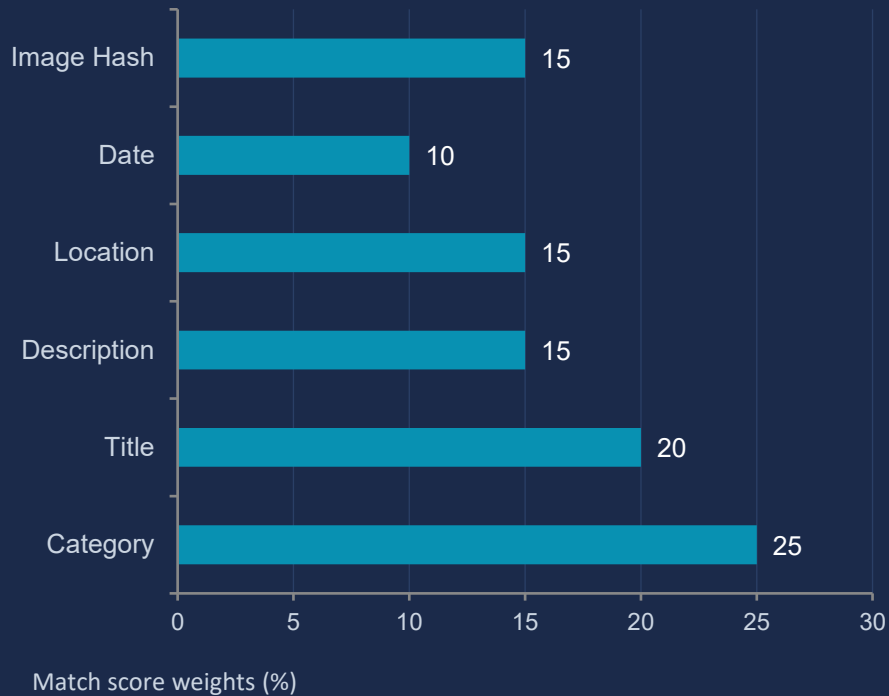
Admin staff spend 3-5 hrs/week fielding lost-item queries manually

FindIt: Post, match, and return — in minutes



Design philosophy: "As easy as Instagram, not as boring as a college portal." Zero passwords. Photo-first. Under 10 seconds to post.

Smart matching across 6 signals



Edge cases handled



Multiple claims

Poster reviews all claims side-by-side; accepting one atomically rejects others



Fake claims

Proof-of-ownership field prompts claimers for details only the real owner would know



Location mismatch

Partial credit scoring — wallet lost at Main Building can match one found at Bus Stop



No photos

Text + category + location matching still works; photos boost score by up to 15%

From prototype to campus-wide impact

3-5x

Improvement in
item return rate

<2 hrs

Avg. time from
lost to matched

60-70%

Items posted digitally
vs. <10% on boards

Immediate (pilot-ready)

- Deploy link on student portal
- Announce via email to one hostel block
- Collect feedback for 2-week pilot

With more time (v2)

- Campus SSO / magic-link authentication
- Push notifications via PWA
- Admin dashboard with analytics
- CLIP-based image similarity

Ready for a pilot. Zero cost. One link on the student portal is all it takes.